

A COPTIC PALIMPSEST.

*I. Prayer of the Virgin in "Bartos."**II. Fragment of a Patriarchal History.*

BY W. E. CRUM.

This MS. was acquired by the British Museum a few years ago. It is numbered *Or.* 4714. For the permission to publish it I have to thank Professor Douglas, Keeper of the Oriental MSS. I must also acknowledge the consent of the Rev. George Horner; for though the MS. reached England in his possession, he generously resigned his claims upon its publication to me.

The MS. was obtained at Siut. It consists of six consecutive leaves of coarse vellum, in book form, each now about $6\frac{1}{2}$ in. $\times$ 5 in. It is a palimpsest; but the earlier text is so faintly visible, that even had the original leaves not been cut down to accommodate the subsequent scribe, little would now be legible.

I. Prayer of the Virgin in "Bartos."

This is the later text. It is in a single column and in very black ink. The characters are thick, coarsely formed, and incline to the right. None of the published facsimiles have much resemblance to the type exhibited, for they represent almost exclusively the careful literary scripts, while the rougher colophons show only Bohairic hands. Hyvernât, *Album* xii, 3 is a finer and presumably earlier specimen of a somewhat similar style. It may safely be assigned to a date not before the 11th century. The lines in a page vary between 15 and 25. The pages are numbered $\overline{\text{B}}$ — $\overline{\text{IV}}$. The text is that of the magical prayer said to have been made by the Virgin on behalf of S. Matthias in "the city of Bartos," *i.e.*, among the Parthians.¹ It

¹ v. Guidi in *Soc. as. ital., Giornale*, 1889, 173.

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is already known in Ethiopic and Arabic versions, presumably derived from the Coptic. For the Ethiopic version I have used M. Basset's translation;¹ for the Arabic, the description and excerpts of the Bodleian MS. *Rot. or.* 2,² a curious amulet not mentioned by M. Basset. Both these versions, the former especially, appear to be developed to a much greater length than the Coptic which, while retaining signs of a higher antiquity (*e.g.*, the use of the old Gnostic word *ἀπολογία*), is unadorned by many of the glosses and expansions seen in the others (*e.g.*, the names of the five nails).³ It is said that this prayer and the consecrated water and oil to which it refers were used in a particular (penitential or exorcising?) ritual of the Ethiopic church,⁴ and its composition is attributed in the Arabic version to Cyril of Jerusalem.

P. β. [ειϰη]ΤΕΙ ΑΠΟΚ ΞΗΠΔΕΙΩΤ ΞΗΠΕΠ̄ΝΔ
 ΕΤΟΥΔΔΒ ΠΑΡΑΠΕ ΑΛΦΑ ΠΡΑΠ ΞΗΠΔΕΙΩΤΠΕ
 ΑΡΩΔ ΔΑΠΗΛ ΠΡΑΠ ΞΗΠΕΠ̄ΝΔ ΕΤΟΥΔΔΒΠΕ
 ΞΠΑΡΑΚΛΗΤΟΣ ΑΝΘΡΩΠΩΝΤΠΟΥΤΕ ΠΟΥΩΤ
 ΚΑΤΑ ΤΚΕΛΗΥΣΙΣ ΞΗΠΔΕΙΩΤ ΞΗΠΕΠ̄ΝΔ
 ΕΤΟΥΔΔΒ ΔΙΤΕΙ ΞΞΩ Ω ΞΑΡΙΑ ΤΑΞΔΔΥ
 ΧΕΚΔΣ ΕΡΕΠΕΤΓΗΠΕΥΤΕΚΟ ΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΞΑΡΙΑ ΔΕ
 ΔΣΔΖΕΡΑΤΣ ΔΣΠΑΡΥ ΠΠΕΣΒΙΧ ΕΒΟΛ ΠΣΑ
 ΠΤΑΠΑΤΟΛΗ ΕΡΕΠΕΣΒΔΛ ΡΙΚΕ . . . ΤΠΕ
 ΨΔΠΕ[ΣΥΗΡΕ] ΞΞΕΡΙ[Τ 8 or 9 letters]ΡΣ
 [about 10 letters]

P. γ. ΕΣΧΩ ΞΞΟΣ ΧΕΔΠΟΚΠΕ ΞΑΡΙΖΔΞ ΔΠΟΚΠΕ
 ΞΑΡΙΑ ΔΠΟΚΠΕ ΤΑΞΔΔΥ ΞΠΩΠΖ ΞΠΚΟΣΞΟΣ
 ΤΗΡΥ ΕΙΩΨ ΖΡΔΙ ΕΡΟΚ ΠΔΠΟΥΤΕ ΔΥΩ ΠΔΨΗΡΕ
 ΔΥΩ ΠΔΞΕΡΙΤ ΔΥΩ ΠΑΡΡΟ ΔΠΟΚΠΕ ΞΑΡΙΑ
 ΤΕΚΞΔΔΥ ΕΙΩΨ ΖΡΔΙ ΕΡΟΚ ΧΕΚΔΣ ΕΚΕΣΩΤΞ

¹ *Les Apocryphes éthiopiens* V. Paris, 1895.

² *v.* Uri-Nicholl's Catalogue, II, 482. But this is now numbered *Marsh. or.* 131 (R).

³ For this curious palindrome "Sator areto tenet otera rotas," *v.* besides the citations in Heim, *Incantamenta*, Krall in the *Rainer Mittheilungen* V, who regards it as probably not older than the 8th century.

⁴ *v.* Basset, p. 7.

ⲡⲁⲙ ⲙⲡⲉϣⲉⲓⲱⲧ ϫⲁⲓⲣⲉ ⲧⲧⲁⲡⲣⲟ ⲡⲧⲁⲥ-
 ϫⲓⲣⲱⲧⲉ ϩⲡⲡⲁⲉⲕⲓⲃⲉ ⲙⲡⲁⲣⲑⲉⲡⲓⲕⲟⲡ ϫⲁⲓⲣⲉ
 ⲧⲃⲓϫ ⲡⲧⲁⲥⲡⲗⲁⲥⲥⲉ ⲡⲁⲁⲙ ⲡⲡⲉⲓⲱⲧ ϫⲁⲓⲣⲉ
 ⲡⲟⲩⲉ-

Р. Ѡ. ϣⲏⲧⲉ ⲡⲧⲁⲩⲙⲟⲟϣⲉ ϩⲙⲡⲁⲣⲁⲁⲓⲥⲟⲥ ⲡⲓⲁⲓ
 ⲡⲥⲟⲡ ϫⲁⲓⲣⲉ ⲡⲗⲟⲩⲟⲥ ⲡⲓⲱⲧ¹ ϩⲉⲡⲟⲩⲙⲉ ϫⲁⲓⲣⲉ
 ⲡⲡⲧⲁϣϫⲟⲥ ⲡⲁⲓ ϫⲉⲁⲓⲧⲉⲓ (ⲁⲓⲧⲉⲓⲛ) ⲙⲙⲟ[ⲓ] ⲱ
 ⲧⲁⲙⲁⲁⲩ ⲙⲡⲉⲧⲣⲟⲩϣϣ² ⲧⲁⲧⲁⲁϣ ⲡⲉ ⲁⲓⲁⲓⲧ
 ⲡⲧⲡⲣⲟⲥⲉⲩϫⲏ ϫⲉⲕⲁⲥ ϣⲧⲁⲗⲃⲟ³ ⲡⲡⲉⲧϣⲱⲡⲉ
 ⲡⲓⲏⲧⲥ ⲙⲡⲡⲉⲧⲥⲣⲙ⁴ ⲙⲡⲡⲉⲧⲣⲃⲣⲟⲓ ϩⲡⲡⲉϣ-
 ⲧⲉⲕⲟ ⲙⲡⲟⲩⲟⲡ ⲡⲓⲙ ⲉⲧⲑⲗⲓⲃⲉ (ⲑⲗⲓⲃⲉⲓⲛ) ϩⲡⲡⲉⲡⲡⲁ
 ⲡⲁⲕⲁⲑⲁⲣⲧⲟⲡ ⲡⲧⲃⲱϣ ⲡⲁⲡ ⲡⲁⲓ

Р. ⲑ. ⲁⲉ ⲉⲥϫⲱ ⲙⲙⲟⲟⲩ ⲡⲃⲓ ⲧⲡⲁⲣⲑⲉⲡⲟⲥ ⲁⲥⲃⲱϣⲧ
 ϩⲓⲟⲩⲡⲁⲙ ⲙⲙⲟⲥ ⲉⲥⲡⲁⲩ ⲉⲙⲓϫⲁⲏⲗ ⲙⲡⲧⲁⲃ-
 ϣⲓⲏⲗ ϩⲓⲓⲃⲟⲩⲣ ⲙⲙⲟⲥ ⲁⲥϣⲧⲟⲣⲧⲣ ⲡⲧⲉⲩⲡⲟⲩ
 ⲡⲉϫⲉ ⲧⲁⲃⲣⲓⲏⲗ ⲡⲁⲥ ϫⲉⲙⲡⲣⲣⲓⲓⲟⲧⲉ ⲱ ⲙⲁⲣⲓⲁ
 ⲁⲡⲟⲕⲡⲉ ⲧⲁⲃⲣⲓⲏⲗ ⲡⲉⲡⲧⲁϣⲉⲓⲡⲉ ⲡϣⲙⲡⲟⲩⲃⲉ
 ⲙⲡⲟⲩⲣⲏⲡⲉ⁵ ⲡⲧⲁⲉⲓ ϣⲁⲣⲱ ⲧⲁϫⲱⲕ ⲉⲃⲟⲗ
 ⲙⲡⲟⲩⲁⲓⲧⲏⲙⲁ ⲙⲡⲡⲉⲧⲣϣⲓⲡⲉ ⲡⲥⲱϣ ⲡⲉϫⲉ
 ⲙⲁⲣⲓⲁ ϫⲉⲡⲓⲙⲡⲉ ⲡⲁⲓ ⲉⲧⲉⲣⲉⲡⲉⲓⲣⲁⲃⲧⲟⲥ
 (ⲣⲁⲃⲃⲟⲥ) ⲡⲡⲟⲃ⁶ ⲉⲓⲡⲧⲉϣⲃⲓϫ ⲡⲉϫⲁϣ ⲡⲁⲥ
 ϫⲉⲡⲁⲓⲡⲉ ⲙⲓϫⲁⲏⲗ ⲡⲡⲟⲃ^{sic} ϩⲡⲧⲁⲡⲕⲉⲗⲕⲉ
 (ⲁⲓⲓⲉⲗⲏ?)⁷ ⲧⲏⲣⲥ ⲡⲡⲁⲓⲧⲧⲉⲗⲟⲥ ⲡⲧⲟⲥ ⲁⲉ

Р. ⲓ. ⲁⲥϫⲓ ⲡⲁⲥ ⲡⲟⲩⲥⲙⲏ ⲉⲥⲓⲟⲗⲃ ⲡⲉϫⲁⲥ ϫⲉ[ⲧ]ⲧⲁⲣⲕⲟ
 ⲙⲙⲟⲕ ⲙⲡⲟⲟⲩ ⲙⲓϫⲁⲏⲗ ⲧⲱⲣⲕ ⲉⲣⲟⲕ
 ⲙⲡⲁϣⲏⲣⲉ ⲡⲉⲡⲧⲁϣϣⲓ ⲙⲡⲉⲓⲣⲁⲃⲧⲟⲥ ϩⲡⲧⲃⲓϫ

¹ For ⲙⲡⲉⲓⲱⲧ.

² For ⲟⲩⲱϣϣ.

³ For ⲉⲣⲉⲣⲧⲁⲗⲃⲟ.

⁴ For ⲥⲟⲣⲙ.

⁵ ? For ⲙⲡⲟⲩⲉⲓⲣⲏⲡⲏ.

⁶ For ⲡⲟⲩⲃ.

⁷ Or ⲁⲓⲓⲉⲗⲏⲕⲓⲏ. Cf. BUDGE, *St. Michael*, 116, where ⲧⲁⲓⲧⲧⲉⲗⲓ
 ⲧⲏⲣⲥ = جميع عساكر الملائكة (v. Guidi in *L'Oriente* II, 83).

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εϣοοπ ηζητϣ τη¹ ερθε ποϣοειϣ η[κ]αζ
 ποττη τωρκ εροκ ~~α~~πτο~~ν~~ ηιβτ ηταζο²
 επεκ~~ω~~αα ετο~~α~~αδ ζηπε~~ς~~ο~~ς~~ (σταυρός)
 χεκα^{??}ς εκεχοο[[?] 1 or 2 letters] η [11 or 12 letters]
 P. 17. ηαγγελο[?]ς ησεαζερατο[?] ηαααι ϣατε³
 ηετ~~ζ~~ααηητ χωκ εβολ ετεπ~~α~~οο[?] ηαι
 αηηηεζ ετκη ζραι αηαατο εβολ ααρε^{sic}
 ϣαπε ποαοο[?] ηταλβο ζαηααα ηηηη
 χεκα[?]ς ζητε^{sic}ηο[?] εϣαηααα ηηηη
 ησεπατ ααο[?] ηβι ηηα ηηη ηηακαθαρτοη
 αα εϣαπε αηρζαδ ερο[?] ααρε[?]κτο[?]
 εηηταηη αηεητα[?]ςζα[?]ι[?]ο[?] ζητετβοα
 αηεκραη χωρε ις ηε^{sic}χς ηαϣηρε ααε[?]ριτ
 ααρε[?]ηηη[?]ς ηηηηη ϣαπε εϣε[?]αη[ε](αὐξάνειν)
 αηετ[?]ε[?]ψ[?]α[?]χη αηηε [1 or 2 letters] ηε[?]ρθε
 αηεζοο[?] ητα[?]α[?]ηο[?] ηηηητ χεαηοκπε
 ααρια τεκ[?]αα[?]α εηα[?]ρακαλει ααοκ ις
 [η]α[?]ηηρε α[?]α [9 or 10 letters] ε ττ [8 or 9 letters].

P. 18. ["No one knows this prayer except] me and my Father
 and the Holy Spirit. Alpha is my name; the name of my Father
 is Arôa Daniel;⁴ the name of the Holy Spirit, the Comforter —?
 We are in one divinity, according to the command of my Father
 and the Holy Spirit. I send (*lit.* give) thee Maria, my mother, that
 those that are in prison may come forth."

¹ ? For [η]τε[?]α-, a rare form of Sa'id. conjunctive.

² For ? ητα[?]ατοκσο[?].

³ For ϣαητε.

⁴ Cf. F. Rossi, *Trattato Gnostico* (Mem. Acad. Torino, ser. II, xliii),
 f. 17, where in certain mystical, "holy names of the Father" the name
 Daniel is declared to be hidden; ηαι ερε[?]αηηηλ ζηη ηηηητ
 (/. ζητο[?]). The Eth. and Ar. versions have Ala and Ô for the Father's,
 Arâdyâl for the Holy Spirit's name. Perhaps therefore read αα[?]ραααηηηλ.

Then (ⲁⲉ) Maria stood and stretched forth her hands [to] the eastern side, while her eyes were turned toward heaven, to her beloved son (p. Ⲯ) and she said, "I am Mariham (ⲙⲁⲣⲓⲁⲙ),¹ I am Maria, I am the mother of the Life of the whole World! I cry aloud to Thee, my God and my Son and my Beloved and my King, I Maria, Thy mother, do cry aloud to Thee, that Thou mayst hear my voice and send to me the light of all the powers of heaven, the angels and the archangels, the Cherubim and the Seraphim and all the host of heaven and that they [may fulfil for me all things] (p. ⲁ) that are in my heart and everything by their means, whether evil or good. For Thy name it is that is my helper by day and night. Adonai! Let the stone be overturned, let it break before this water and this oil! Let the irons be loosed (*or* melted) from the door closed and hidden; let them open forthwith to me! Let the powers depart from NN., the son of NN. (p. Ⲉ) or any place in which this prayer shall be said; for I will arise² early and will say thus; Hail to the good Father, who sent His angel Gabriel to me and brought me the good tidings. Hail to the throne of glory on which He sits. Hail to the diadem which is upon His head (?). Hail to the (p. Ⲯ) seven secret names that are hidden in it, namely AEH[I]OTΩ. Hail to the seven veils that are spread upon His holy tabernacle. Hail to the seven pillars that stand by it (?). Hail to the first word that came forth from the Father's mouth³ (as) He sent Gabriel saying, 'Say to Maria, lo, my son cometh to thee.' Hail, my beloved Son. Hail, true king. Hail to the first-born of His Father and the first-born of my womb. Hail to the throne on which He sits at the right hand of His Father. Hail to the mouth that took milk from my virgin breasts. Hail to the hand that formed Adam, our father. Hail to the feet (p. Ⲭ) that often walked in Paradise. Hail to the true Word [of] the Father. Hail to Him that said to me, 'Ask of Me, oh! My mother, what thou wouldest and I will give it thee. I have given this prayer that thou mightest heal by it the sick and those that are gone astray and that are wretched in the prisons and everyone that is tormented by unclean spirits.' Relieve us!"⁴ (p. Ⲯ) But as the Virgin said these [words],

¹ A form of the name frequent in the *Pist. Soph.* and *Pap. Bruce.*

² *Lit.* I will have already arisen.

³ *Cf.* Rossi, *l.c.*, f. 14.

⁴ *Lit.* conjunctive, apparently after 'Hail,' with ethic dative.

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she looked upon her right hand and seeing Michael and Gabriel upon her left, forthwith was affrighted. Gabriel said to her, "Fear not, oh, Maria! I am Gabriel that brought the good tidings of thy peace(?), and that came to thee and fulfilled thy request and that for which thou didst ask." Maria said to him, "Who is this in whose hand is the golden staff?" He said to her, "This is Michael, the greatest in the whole host of angels." Then (δέ) she (p. 1) raised (*lit.* took) a sweet voice and said, "I conjure thee this day, Michael, and adjure thee by my Son, who took the staff from the hand of Mastema and gave it to thee and gave thee a famous name; I conjure thee and will not release thee till thou fulfil for me all the incantations¹ of my tongue, namely, this water and this oil that are before me; that they may be for healing in [the body?] (p. 12) of NN., the son of NN., that he may be as new in his bones, removing from him every sickness and every trouble and every infirmity and every plot of the Adversary. Let them depart from every one who shall wash in this water and this oil, through the power of God Almighty. Let there retire from him every unclean spirit, each one going to his place through the might of our holy prayer. (P. 13) I conjure thee, too, Gabriel, that brought me the good tidings of the birth of my son; I conjure thee and adjure thee and will not release thee till thou fulfil for me all the incantations of my tongue, so that in the hour in which I shall wash in this water and this oil, I NN., the son of NN. [thou mayst?] draw thy (?) sharp sword² which pursues the demons in the place where they are, so that they (?) become like dust of the earth [in?] a wind. I adjure Thee by the five nails that were fixed in Thy holy body upon the cross, that Thou send [me a host?] of (p. 14) angels, that they may stand with me until what is in my heart be fulfilled, namely this water and this oil that lie in my presence. Let them (*MS.* it) become a water of healing in the body of NN., that in the hour in which he shall wash in it, every unclean spirit may flee from him, and if he is being (magically) practised

¹ Or "charms." 'Απολογία is a Gnostic term for the phrases, generally ἐφέσια γράμματα, by the potency of which the supernatural powers could be compelled. *v. Pap. Bruce*, ed. C. Schmidt, pp. 127, 215, 478, etc., also *Pist. Soph.*, 291, etc. This, no doubt, is also the meaning of ΑΠΟΛΟ/, so frequent in Rossi's *Trattato*, and which Amélineau (*Nouv. traité gnost.*, p. 11) does not explain. ΧΩΚ

ΕΒΟΛ must here mean "conform to."

² Cf. *A.Z.* xxxiv, 87.

upon, let it (*i.e.* the spirit) return upon the head of him that invoked (? *lit.* wrote) it (*lit.* them),¹ through the might of Thy strong name, Jesus the Christ, my beloved son. Let NN., the son of NN., increase in (?) his soul and [his — ?] and become as on the day on which he was born. For I am Maria, Thy mother. I call upon Thee, Jesus, my son and (?)”

II. *Fragment of a Patriarchal History.*

The earlier text with which all six leaves were covered is written in two columns, in a small sloping hand, of Zoega's 9th class. It is probably therefore of no great age.

My attention was first attracted by the name of “the Bishop Zoilus,” which shows that the texts relate to that obscure period of the Monophysite struggle during which Justinian had attempted, by the deposition of the intractable Jacobite Theodosius² and the appointment of Paul,³ to restore the Catholic predominance in the distracted church of Alexandria. Paul's tenure of office was however short, and in 541 he too was deposed by a synod at Gaza and succeeded by Zoilus,⁴ the Jacobite majority still regarding the exiled Theodosius as their true patriarch.

What our MS. offers is far too meagre to be of much assistance in clearing up obscurities. Most of such sentences as can be consecutively deciphered are cast in the 1st pers. pl., and appear to address now one, now several hearers. Of narrative passages almost nothing remains. Some 30 lines can be counted in the best preserved pages, with the lower, but never the upper margins. The speeches which occur are signalized by quotation-marks at each line. The lacunæ are of too uncertain size to be exactly measured, and the dots here printed bear no relation to their extent. The readings

¹ A tentative translation. The pronouns appear to be confused.

² M. Revillout promised a Life of Theodosius years ago (*v. Les Blemmyes* 66), but has not as yet published it.

³ There is a confusion in the Arabic texts between Paul of Tanis and of Tabennese. Those of Severus in the Brit. Mus. (*Or.* 26100, ff. 46, 47 and *Or.* 1338, ff. 49, 50) show complete uncertainty. John of Nikiou (transl. p. 516) has clearly Tabennese. Eutychius has merely “Paul.”

⁴ Of Zoilus nothing is known. He came, according to John of Nikiou (p. 282), from “the town of Ἀκλάνια” *Āklanyā*. The continuator of Zacharias Rhetor (*Land, Anecd.* III, 316) calls him a monk, **ⲁⲓⲃⲏⲛⲓ**, whom the members of the Gaza Synod brought from Palestine to Alexandria. I owe this reference to Mr. E. W. Brooks.

and restitutions are often most questionable. The pages are here indicated by the numbers which they bear referring to the later text (no. I *above*). As to their sequence only so much can be said: that the pairs $\overline{\text{B}}$, $\overline{\text{IV}}$ and $\overline{\text{V}}$, $\overline{\text{IB}}$; $\overline{\text{IA}}$, $\overline{\text{A}}$ and $\overline{\text{I}}$, $\overline{\text{E}}$; $\overline{\text{F}}$, $\overline{\text{Θ}}$ and $\overline{\text{Z}}$, $\overline{\text{H}}$ are in each case *Recto* and *Verso* of a single fol.; though it may be difficult to decide which are the *Rectos*, which the *Versos*.

A. Pp. $\overline{\text{F}}$, $\overline{\text{Θ}}$ οὐφάντα[σια ἀν] ἀλλὰ καὶ
ἐπῳάν[μο]ῦτε [ερ]ο[φ] χερεφ[φ]μμεεεῖδω-
λον πειετοῦμε πετπχω [μ]μοφ πθε γαρ
ππε[τ]μμεεεε εατερδτσο[οφ]π ετδωρια
μππ[οφ]τε δφ[φμ]φε ππζικων πδι-
μοπιον δφ[οφ]ωφτ μπσωοτ(? σωπτ) π
[πτε]ιζε ζωακ [μ]πεκπιστετε ετμπτ-
[πο]ῦτε μπμοποτε[π]ης εαφρσαρξ κα . πα
. . . [εφ]οφωπζ εβολ πτ[μ]πτοφδ πτετριάς
[ε]τοφδδβ δφω δ τα μμμοκ πρεφ[φμ]-
φερωμε δφω [π]ρεφφμμεεποφτε [δ]π
ζιτμπ πε $\overline{\chi\varsigma}$ [πλ]οτος μπποφτε
μπ[τε]φμπτοφδ πατφδ[χε] ερος¹ ζρδ
πζητς (*margin*) (*col. 2*) πετπμεεε επε $\overline{\chi\rho\varsigma}$
 $\overline{\text{ic}}$ π[μμοπο]γενης πφπ[ρε] πτε πποφτε πα[ι]
ετποφωφτ π[δφ] ζποφπροσκφ[ππ]ςις ποφωτ
τεφσαξ οφρ[ω]μεε γαρ ἀππε [εαφ]μοφ
ζαρπ κα[π] ετετπμεεε ε[ρος] ω πφπρε
ππ[εσ]τωριος πζοφο δ[ε] πφπρε μπδιδβο-
[λος δ]λλὰ πλο[τος] μππ[οφ]τε πω[τ]
ετφοοπ ζδθπ ππεδωπ τηρ[οφ] πεπταφρ-
ρω[μεε] ζποφμπτατ[πο]βε δφρρωμ[ε]
ζποφχωκ ε[βολ] ζποφ $\overline{\pi\pi\alpha}$ εφ[ο] ζμμεδρια
τε[παρ]θενος ετοφδδ[β] ετταμνφ φδ[επεζ]
δφ† ζωαφ [μπ]ειπ[ε] (*margin*).

“ is no phantasm. And even if we call thee (?) idolater, it is truth that we speak. For like as those, knowing not the gift

¹ As in Zoega 605 *inf*.

Pp. $\overline{\zeta}$, $\overline{\eta}$, col. I, mostly illegible. The words ΝΗΛΗΔΕΚ "with thee," ΝΑΝ "to us," are discernible; further on, the important phrase ΙΟΥΔΑΙΣ ΝΕΡΡΕ "New Judas," يودس الجديد whence we have a clue to the events with which this part at least of the text is concerned. For Severus relates⁴ that this was the name given by the hostile Alexandrians to Justinian's nominee, Paul. The foregoing words make it likely that we have here the reproaches or defiance addressed by the people (or perhaps clergy) to Paul, and this may explain also what we read on pp. $\overline{\epsilon}$, $\overline{\theta}$, where the speakers clearly contrast their (Jacobite) orthodoxy with the heresy of the person they address. Col. II seems also to be in the 1st pers. pl. In it occurs the word ΝΚΑΛΧΙΤΟΝ "of Chalcedon."

B. Pr. $\bar{\iota}\bar{\alpha}$, $\bar{\alpha}$ [o] $\tau\epsilon\lambda\lambda\eta\lambda\eta\gamma\alpha\rho\epsilon\gamma$ $\Delta\tau\omega$ $\psi\alpha\tau\eta\lambda\alpha\tau$
 $\eta\chi\theta\epsilon\iota\varsigma$ $\kappa\eta\lambda\eta\eta\theta\epsilon\iota\varsigma$ $\epsilon\rho\omega\eta$ $\psi\alpha\beta\omega\lambda$ $\eta\epsilon\kappa\theta\omega\eta\tau$
 $\eta\lambda\lambda\omega\tau\gamma$ $\eta\theta\epsilon$ $\eta\omega\tau\kappa\omega\gamma\tau$ $\eta\omega\gamma\tau$ $\eta\tau\epsilon\kappa\omega\rho\tau\eta$
 $\epsilon\chi\eta\eta\gamma\epsilon\theta\eta\varsigma$ $\epsilon\tau\epsilon\lambda\lambda\eta\eta$ [o] $\tau\varsigma\omega\tau\omega\eta\tau$ $\Delta\tau\omega$ [e] $\chi\eta$
 $[\eta\eta\eta\eta\tau\epsilon\rho\omega]$ $\epsilon\tau\epsilon\lambda\lambda\eta\eta\omega\tau\epsilon\pi\iota\kappa\alpha\lambda\epsilon\iota$ [e] $\eta\epsilon\kappa\rho\alpha\eta$
 $\chi\epsilon\Delta\tau$ [o] $\tau\omega\eta\eta$ $\eta\iota\alpha\kappa\omega\beta$ [$\Delta\tau\omega$] $\Delta\tau\rho$ [$\eta\epsilon\psi$] $\eta\lambda$
 $\eta\chi\alpha\iota\epsilon$ $\gamma\epsilon\eta\kappa\omega\tau$ [e] $\omega\eta$ $\chi\epsilon\Delta\kappa\tau\alpha\Delta$ [τ e] $\tau\omega\tau\omega\tau$
 $\eta\gamma\epsilon$ [$\eta\rho\omega\eta$] e $\eta\lambda\eta\eta\omega\tau$ [$\eta\chi\alpha\chi\epsilon$] $\eta\lambda\omega\sigma\tau\alpha\tau\eta\varsigma$
 $\Delta\tau\omega$ $\epsilon\tau\omega\tau\omega\tau$ $\epsilon\eta\omega\tau\rho\rho\omega$ $\eta\epsilon\psi\chi\eta\eta\theta\omega\eta\varsigma$ $\Delta\tau\omega$

¹ John iv, 10.

² Cf. Apoc. ix, 20.

³ Cf. Rom. i, 25.

⁴ Renaudot, p. 141.

MAY 4]

[ⲙ]ⲡⲟⲛⲏⲣⲟⲥ ⲡⲁⲣⲁ [ⲡ]ⲕⲁⲑ ⲧⲏⲣϥ [ⲁ]ⲡⲟⲛ ϫⲉⲁⲛ
 [ⲡ]ϫⲟⲓⲥ ⲡⲁⲣⲁ ⲛ[ⲑⲉⲑ]ⲡⲟⲥ ⲧⲏⲣⲟϥ [ⲁϥ]ⲱ
 ⲧⲡⲑⲃⲃⲏⲛϥ [ⲡⲁⲣⲁ] ⲡⲕⲁⲑ ⲧⲏⲣϥ ⲉⲧⲃⲉⲡⲉⲡ-
 ⲡⲟⲃⲉ (*margin*) (*col. 2*) ⲟϣⲁⲉ ⲟϣⲁⲉ
 ϣⲟϥⲑⲏⲛ[ⲉ] ⲧⲁⲗ[ⲱⲟϥ] ⲙⲡ[ⲉⲕ]ⲙⲧⲟ ⲉⲃⲟⲗ
 ⲉⲧⲣⲉⲡ ⲁⲡⲟⲛ ϫⲉⲡⲟⲣⲑⲟⲗ[ⲟϣ]ⲟ[ⲥ
 ⲑⲏ]ⲟϥⲡⲁⲣⲏⲥ[ⲁ] ⲧⲏⲡⲁ ⲙⲙⲟⲕ
 ⲙⲙⲱⲉ ⲙⲡⲡⲡⲟϥⲧⲉ ⲙⲡⲙⲧⲟ ⲙⲡⲡⲣⲱⲙⲉ
 ⲙⲡ[ⲡⲉϥ]ϣⲙⲱⲉ ⲡⲁⲥⲉⲃⲏ[ⲥ] ⲉⲧⲑⲟⲟϥ ⲃ?ⲧⲉ
 ⲉⲣⲟⲛ ⲁⲛ ⲉⲙⲁⲧⲉ ⲉⲑⲉⲣⲉⲥ[ⲓⲥ] ⲙⲑⲧⲥ[ⲓⲥ] ⲥⲏⲧⲉ
 ⲧⲁⲓ ⲡⲧⲱⲧⲏ ⲉⲧⲉⲧⲏⲭⲟⲙ[ⲙ]ⲟⲥ (*margin*).

" a place to dwell in. And how long, Lord, wilt Thou be wroth with us for ever? Shall thy fury blaze as a fire? Pour out Thine anger upon the nations that have not known Thee and upon the kingdoms that have not called upon Thy name; for they have devoured Jacob, they have made his place desert.¹ Others too hast Thou given into the hand of lawless and apostate hostile men, and into the hand of a King violent and wicked above all the earth.² As for us, we have the Lord above all nations, and we are humbled beyond all the earth because of our sins neither nor incense offered (?) in Thy presence, that we may we orthodox openly we will Thee contend with God before with men and with their evil worship not to us only the heresy of two natures which ye say (?) "

Pp. 1̄, ̄ε. On these nothing can be read. The prayer of which the above is a passage is offered by the Monophysites, probably on account of the unsympathetic treatment they had received at the Emperor's hands. The last words seem however to be addressed to the Catholics; but the reading is very doubtful.

C. Pp. ̄β, ̄ιϥ. Very little legible at first. . . . ⲡⲱⲣϥ
 ⲉⲡⲉⲡⲉⲣⲏⲛ ϫⲉⲡⲡⲉⲧⲉⲓⲙⲉ ⲉⲧⲉ? ⲡⲟⲗ[ⲓⲥ] ⲁϥ ⲡⲭⲟⲓ
 ⲡⲧⲁⲡⲉⲓ ⲑⲓⲱⲱϥ ^{sic} ⲙⲡⲧⲁⲡⲟⲑⲏⲕⲏ ?ⲧⲏ
 ⲉⲧⲟⲟⲧϥ ϫ[ⲉ]ⲑⲟⲧⲁⲛ ⲉⲕϣⲁⲡⲡⲁϥ ⲉⲣⲟⲛ ⲉⲡⲁ-
 ⲙⲁⲑⲧⲉ ⲙⲡⲉⲡ[ⲓⲕⲟⲡⲟⲥ] ⲑⲟⲣⲟⲕ (? *for* ⲑⲱ ⲉⲣⲟⲕ)

¹ Ps. lxxix, 5 ff.² Dan iii, 32 (Song of 3 Child.).

ϣΑΝΤΗΧΟΟΣ ΝΑΚ ΜΗΠΣΔΟΥΚΟΥΙ ΔΕ ΕΤΕΣΟΥ-
 ΣΝΑΥ ΠΘΩΟΥΤΠΕ ΔΥΙ ΕΤΟΥΝΔΞΙΣ ΠΒΙ ΖΩΗΛΟΣ
 ΠΕΠΙΣΚΟΠΟΣ

" separate ourselves, for they know not the (?) city and the ship upon which we embark and the store [commanded him] saying, 'When thou seest us laying hold upon the Bishop, wait (?) until we shall tell thee.'" But after a little, namely upon the 2nd of 'Thoth, the Bishop Zoilus went to the Synaxis "

Pp. $\overline{\text{v}}$, $\overline{\text{ιβ}}$ ζενρωμε πρεϣρποβε ΔΕ
 ΖΗΤΠΙΣΤΙΣ ΜΠΕΝΧΟΕΙΣ $\overline{\text{ic}}$ Π[ΕΧ $\overline{\text{c}}$] ΠΔΙ ΠΤΔΥ-
 ΜΟΥ

"sinful men but in the faith of our Lord Jesus, the Christ, He who died "

Here the first pair of pages seems to refer to some movement for the seizure presumably of Zoilus, the Catholic patriarch. The second pair may be connected with the texts on pp. $\overline{\text{ιβ}}$ ff., and should, if so, precede pp. $\overline{\text{v}}$, $\overline{\text{ιβ}}$.

Would it be possible by the help of the above data—the day of the month and the celebration of the Communion,—to fix the year for these events?

The next Meeting of the Society will be held at 37, Great Russell Street, Bloomsbury, W.C., on Tuesday, 1st June, 1897, at 8 p.m. when the following Paper will be read:—

MR. H. RASSAM: "Abraham and the Land of his Nativity."